EA Capability Model

We have defined a pragmatic capability model to setup and improve Enterprise Architecture in an organisation.

Enterprise Architecture Capabilities

Architecture Development

Common	Architecture **Vision** Development	Architecture **Roadmap** Development	**Transformation** Planning
	Architecture **Requirements** Management	Architecture **View** Creation	**New Technology** Evaluation
Business Architecture	**Strategic Value** Driver Definition	**Capability** Definition	**Process** Modelling
Application Architecture	Architecture **Validation**	**Application / Solution** Architecture Modelling	**Integration** Architecture Modelling
Data Architecture	**Business Object** Modelling	**Data Architecture** Modelling	**Data Flow** Modelling
Technology Architecture	**System** Architecture Modelling	**Network** Architecture Modelling	**Virtualization** Architecture Modelling

Architecture Repository

- Dashboards, Views, Reports
- Data Gathering & Data Quality
- Repository Support & Maintenance
- AS-IS
- TRANSITION
- TO-BE

Architecture Management

- Organisation Development
- EA Performance Management
- EA Process Development
- EA Knowledge Management
- Stakeholder Management

Architecture Governance, Communication & Change

- Standards, Policies, Principles, Guidelines
- Architecture Training
- Communication & Change Management
- Architecture Compliance Evaluation
- Architecture Review Board

Architecture Vision Development

Align business strategy with architecture direction and gain stakeholder buy-in.

Definition

Architecture Vision Development involves creating a **high-level view of the desired architecture** that aligns with **business goals** and **stakeholder needs**. It sets the direction for the architecture development process.

Objectives

Align the architecture direction with business strategy and stakeholder needs. Create a shared understanding of the target architecture and the business value it enables. Secure stakeholder buy-in and signoff on the statement of architecture work.

Tasks

1. **Stakeholder engagement**: Identify key stakeholders and their concerns (create stakeholder map; conduct interviews to gather objectives, concerns, drivers and constraints of each).
2. **Business strategy alignment**: Define the strategic goals and drivers and align the scope and constraints of the architecture effort.
3. **Develop the Architecture Vision** including all relevant artefacts (e.g. business capabilities, application landscape).
4. **Communication** to get approval / signoff.
5. **Baseline assessment** (high-level) and **roadmap definition**, outlining the transition to the architecture vision.

Roles

- Enterprise Architect (R)
- CIO (A)
- Business Architect (C)

Inputs

- Business strategy and goals
- Stakeholder concerns and requirements
- Industry trends
- Existing architecture documentation (e.g. architecture principles)

Outputs

- Architecture Vision statement
- High-level architecture models and roadmap
- Stakeholder communication material
- Statement of architecture work

Additional information

- TOGAF Architecture Vision
- Visual Paradigm: Architecture Vision TOGAF
- Every product needs an architecture vision

Common issues with an immature capability:

- **Misalignment between business and IT** without a clear connection between the IT architecture effort and the business strategy.
- **Lack of direction**: teams are unsure what the future state looks like or why transformations are happening.
- **Stakeholder resistance**: key stakeholders are not engaged or do not support a transformation effort.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- Understand and document the **business drivers** and **strategic goals**.
- Clearly define the **scope** (in-scope, out-of-scope and clear priorities).
- Use **simple visuals** and **describe the future state** (how will the business operate and how will technology enable it).
- **Success metrics**: define measurable outcomes.

Architecture Roadmap Development

Provide a clear path towards a target architecture, aligned with business goals and priorities.

Definition

Architecture Roadmap Development involves creating a **strategic plan** that outlines the steps and milestones needed to achieve a target architecture. It provides a clear timeline and prioritization from the current state to the desired future state.

Objectives

Define a **structured transition path from current to target architecture**. Prioritize initiatives based on business value, strategic alignment and dependencies. Provide a clear timeline with milestones to guide execution and track progress.

Tasks

1. **Current state assessment**: review and analyse the current state architecture to identify gaps, inefficiencies and opportunities.
2. **Target architecture definition**: reference and refine the target architecture (developed as part of the Architecture Vision).
3. **Gap analysis**: identify the gaps between the current state and the target architecture.
4. **Initiative identification**: define initiatives, projects or work packages required to address the gap.
5. **Roadmap development**: establish a timeline, including key phases and milestones.
6. **Resource planning**: identify the resource needs to execute the roadmap.

Roles

- Business Architect, Application Architect, Data Architect, Technology Architect (R)
- Lead Enterprise Architect (A)

Inputs

- Current state architecture.
- Target architecture.
- Business strategy and goals.
- Resource availabilities (budget, people, technology).

Outputs

- Architecture Roadmap document.
- Transition architecture models.
- Implementation plans.
- Prioritized initiative backlog

Additional information

- TOGAF Opportunities and Solutions

Common issues with an immature capability:

- **Lack of direction** and **redundancies** in the application landscape.
- **Unrealistic** and **"pressured" timelines**, due to a lack of strategic planning.
- **Scope creep** and too many **scope changes**.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- **Good understanding** of the current situation and **good knowledge** of **key dependencies.**
- **Well defined priorities** that are based on business objectives and are broken down into **incremental milestones**.
- **Realistic resource planning**, allowing for **flexibility** and **iteration**.
- **Clear, visual roadmap** that is easy to understand for everyone (business and IT) and is communicated to everyone.

Transformation Planning

Aligning with business goals and minimizing disruption through a structured and coordinated approach.

Definition

Transformation Planning involves developing a **comprehensive plan** to transition from the current state to the target architecture. It includes identifying the **necessary steps**, **resources**, and **timelines** to achieve the desired transformation.

Objectives

Translate the architecture roadmap into **actionable transformation plans**. Define work packages, dependencies, resource needs and governance to enable controlled execution with minimal disruption.

Tasks

1. **Dependency analysis**: identify cross-project dependencies, risks and sequencing constraints.
2. **Work package definition**: break roadmap initiatives into actionable work packages with owners.
3. **Transition architecture design**: define intermediate states between current and target.
4. **Resource and budget allocation**: assign resources, budget and timelines per work package.
5. **Stakeholder alignment:** validate and approve the transformation plan with key stakeholders..

Roles

- Business Architect, Application Architect, Data Architect, Technology Architect (R)
- Lead Enterprise Architect (A)

Inputs

- Architecture Roadmap
- Business strategy and goals
- Resource availabilities (budget, people, technology)
- Risk assessments and dependency information

Outputs

- Transformation Plan document with work packages
- Transition architecture models
- Resource and budget allocation plan
- Risk and dependency register

Additional information

- Migration Planning (TOGAF)

Common issues with an immature capability:

- **"Rogue" projects** that are not in line with the overall strategy and enterprise architecture
- **Unrealistic timelines** (overly ambitious) and project timelines that are not aligned to each other
- Scope creep and **unclear prioritization**

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- Align the project portfolio on **strategic objectives** of the projects
- Define **high-level priorities** across projects / initiatives
- Setup a **holistic risk management** across all projects / initiatives
- Define clear governance for transformation decisions and change requests

Architecture Requirements Management

Ensure all needs are identified, understood and communicated throughout architecture development.

Definition

Architecture Requirements Management involves managing and governing the requirements throughout the architecture development process. It ensures that all requirements are **identified**, **documented**, and **addressed** in the architecture.

Objectives

Ensure **all architecture requirements** are systematically **captured, prioritized and traceable to business goals.** Manage changes to requirements in a controlled way to prevent scope creep and misalignment.

Tasks

1. **Identify** and **document requirements**
2. **Analyse requirements** and **prioritize** based on business value, urgency and feasibility.
3. **Document requirements** in a **structured form** (ensure traceability to business goals) and establish and monitor baseline requirements.
4. **Manage** changes to **requirements** (use a repository to track changes and ensure version control).
5. **Traceability** and **impact analysis**: establish traceability between requirements and architecture decisions; assess the impact of changes.

Roles

- Business Architect, Application Architect, Data Architect, Technology Architect (R)
- Lead Enterprise Architect (A)

Inputs

- New stakeholder requirements.
- Business goals and objectives.
- Existing architecture documentation.

Outputs

- Architecture requirement specifications.
- Requirement impact assessment and prioritization.
- Updated requirements repository.

Additional information

- TOGAF ARM

Common issues with an immature capability:

- Unclear requirements and **misalignment**, leading to stakeholder dissatisfaction.
- **Scope creep** (requirements keep getting added).
- **Poor traceability** (how do requirements link to the architecture and how will they be validated).

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- **Understand your stakeholders** and clearly formulate what you want to achieve.
- Establish **simple categories** (must-have, nice-to-have) and **push for strict prioritization**; understanding why something is a must, also helps understanding requirements better.
- **Standardize requirements documentation** and train everyone involved on how to write requirements well.

Architecture View Creation

Facilitate effective decision-making by addressing specific stakeholder concerns.

Definition

Architecture View Creation involves developing various perspectives (views) of the architecture to address the concerns of different stakeholders. These views help in understanding, analysing, and communicating the architecture.

Objectives

Provide **tailored views** that translate complex architecture data into clear, stakeholder-relevant perspectives. Enable informed decision-making by ensuring views are accurate, up-to-date and aligned with stakeholder concerns.

Tasks

1. **Identify information needs** of EA stakeholders and their key questions/concerns.
2. Select viewpoints and **define which views address which stakeholder concerns** (e.g. business capability map, application landscape, technology lifecycle).
3. **Develop architecture views** using data from the architecture repository.
4. **Validate** views with stakeholders and iterate based on feedback.
5. **Maintain** and update views as architecture data evolves.

Roles

- Business Architect, Application Architect, Data Architect, Technology Architect (R)
- Lead Enterprise Architect (A)

Inputs

- Stakeholder requirements.
- Architecture Repository data.
- Viewpoint catalogue and standards (e.g. ArchiMate)
- Architecture principles and guidelines

Outputs

- Architecture views and models.
- Viewpoint catalogue.
- Validated and approved architecture views.

Additional information

- Developing Architecture Views (TOGAF)

Common issues with an immature capability:

- **Miscommunication** between stakeholders and unclear views on the current situation
- **Overwhelming complexity** of architecture views (i.e. too detailed) or **lack of relevance** of views
- Creating views **takes a long time** with **manual effort** of multiple people

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- Build a **pragmatic** but up-to-date **repository** of your enterprise architecture
- Focus on defining **key views** with **clear purpose** and identify the necessary data for them
- **Integrate** data from existing repositories (e.g. CMDB) and **automate** creation of key views

New Technology Evaluation

Leverage new technologies to stay ahead of trends and achieve business goals.

Definition

New Technology Evaluation involves assessing emerging technologies to determine their potential impact and value to the organization. It includes identifying, analysing, and recommending new technologies for adoption.

Objectives

Systematically **identify, assess and recommend emerging technologies** based on business value, technical fit and organizational readiness. Provide a structured evaluation process to avoid ad-hoc technology decisions.

Tasks

1. **Technology scanning**: identify emerging technologies through market research, trend analysis and vendor engagement.
2. **Feasibility assessment**: evaluate technical fit, business value, risks and organizational readiness.
3. **Proof-of-concept:** conduct pilots or prototypes to validate assumptions.
4. **Recommendation**: create technology evaluation reports with clear adoption recommendations.
5. **Standards update**: feed approved technologies into the technology standards and roadmap..

Roles

- Application Architect, Data Architect, Technology Architect (R)
- Lead Enterprise Architect (A)

Inputs

- Business strategy and goals.
- Technology trends and market analysis.
- Existing technology landscape.

Outputs

- Technology evaluation reports and recommendations
- Proof-of-concept / pilot results
- Updated technology standards and approved technology list

Additional information

- Gartner Hype Cycle / Technology Radar
- TOGAF Technology Architecture

Common issues with an immature capability:

- **Ad-hoc decision making** has led to sub-optimal IT solutions.
- **Overwhelmed teams** and **inability to decide** on new technologies.
- **High costs** and **low value** from IT solutions.
- New technologies have been implemented but are **poorly integrated**.
- **No formal process** to evaluate new technologies.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- Define **evaluation criteria** and **conduct market analysis**.
- Evaluate the **technical- and functional-fit** of new technologies.
- Conduct a **proof-of-concept** or pilot.
- Don't chase every trend – **evaluate against concrete business needs** and strategic fit.

Business Architecture – Strategic Value Driver Definition

Identify and articulate the key factors that drive value creation for an organization.

Definition

Strategic Value Driver Definition is the process of **identifying** and **articulating** the **key factors** that drive value creation for an organization. These drivers are critical for aligning business strategies with operational activities to achieve long-term success

Objectives

Define clear, measurable **value drivers that connect business strategy to architecture priorities**. Ensure shared understanding and alignment across business and IT stakeholders.

Tasks

1. **Stakeholder engagement**: conduct interviews and workshops to gather insights on value creation.
2. **Value driver analysis**: analyse business processes and performance data to identify potential value drivers.
3. **Documentation**: define and document strategic value drivers, including their impact on business outcomes.
4. **Strategic alignment**: align value drivers with the organization's strategic goals and objectives.
5. **Communication**: communicate the identified value drivers to stakeholders through presentations and documentation.

Roles

- Business Architect
- Enterprise Architect
- Business Analyst
- Stakeholders (e.g., business leaders, department heads)

Inputs

- Business strategy and objectives
- Performance data and analytics
- Stakeholder insights and expectations
- Industry benchmarks and best practices

Outputs

- Strategic value driver documentation
- Value driver impact analysis
- Alignment matrix with business goals
- Stakeholder communication materials

Additional information

- TOGAF Business Architecture
- Value Stream Mapping
- Business Motivation Model (BMM)

Common issues with an immature capability:

- **Value drivers are too vague** or generic, making them impossible to measure or act upon.
- **Disconnect between business strategy and EA** – value drivers are defined by business without architecture input, or vice versa.
- **No regular review** – value drivers become outdated as business priorities shift.
- Stakeholders don't understand or **don't agree** on what drives value, leading to conflicting priorities.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- Start with the **top 3–5 value drivers** that the business already agrees on – don't try to boil the ocean.
- Ensure each value driver is **measurable** – if you can't measure it, you can't prove architecture's contribution.
- **Co-create with business stakeholders** – value drivers defined in an EA ivory tower won't get buy-in.
- Review and update value drivers **annually** aligned with the strategy cycle.

Business Architecture – Capability Definition

Define what the organization does and how it delivers value.

Definition

Capability Definition involves identifying and defining the core capabilities that an organization needs to achieve its business objectives. It provides a **structured approach** to understanding **what the organization does** and **how it delivers value**.

Objectives

Create a clear and consistent understanding of the organization's core abilities. Enable strategic planning and align business and IT by mapping capabilities to processes, applications and technologies. Support business transformation initiatives by providing a stable reference point.

Tasks

1. **Capability identification** through workshops and interviews and leveraging industry reference architectures
2. **Capability modelling**: define each capability in a structured way (e.g. capability map) and organize them into categories or levels (e.g. strategic, core, supporting).
3. Capability documentation: document each with a clear definition, description and key attributes.
4. **Capability mapping**: map each capability to architecture domains (processes, application, data, technology).
5. Align with stakeholders and finalise

Roles

- Business Architect (R)
- Application Architect, Data Architect, Technology Architect (C)
- Lead Enterprise Architect (A)

Inputs

- Business strategy, business objectives and operating model
- Organizational structure and value chains
- Industry reference models (e.g. BIAN, eTOM)
- Existing capability documentation (if available)

Outputs

- Business capability map (visual representation of the business capabilities)
- Capability descriptions (including maturity assessment)
- Business capability mapping to architecture domains

Additional information

- TOGAF Business Architecture
- Business Capability Mapping (Gartner)
- BIAN (for banking) / eTOM (for telco) as industry reference models

Common issues with an immature capability:

- **Capabilities are defined too granularly** or inconsistently, making the map unusable for strategic discussions.
- **No business ownership** – the capability map is created by IT and not recognized by business.
- **Confusion between capabilities and processes** – leading to unclear scope and duplication.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- Start with a **Level 1–2 capability map** – don't go deeper until you have a validated baseline.
- Use **industry reference models** as a starting point – don't reinvent the wheel.
- Focus on **business ownership** – capabilities must be recognized and validated by business stakeholders, not just IT.
- Keep capability definitions **simple and jargon-free** – if business can't understand it, it won't be used.

Business Architecture – Process Modelling

Visualize and optimize business processes to align operations with strategic goals and drive efficiency.

Definition

Process Modelling involves creating visual representations of business processes to **understand, analyse, and optimize** how work is performed. It provides a clear view of activities, roles, systems, and information flows, enabling **effective process design and improvement**.

Objectives

Create clear and comprehensive process models that enable process optimization, support business transformation initiatives, and ensure alignment between business operations and IT systems. Facilitate communication and understanding of business processes among stakeholders.

Tasks

1. **Identify, prioritize and document** key business processes (based on business impact, complexity, transformation needs). Conduct process discovery workshops with process owners and stakeholders to understand current state processes.
2. **Analyse and document detail processes** including activities, decision points, inputs/outputs, roles and responsibilities. Create process models using standard notation (e.g., BPMN, flowcharts, swimlane diagrams).
3. **Design optimized future processes** by identifying inefficiencies, bottlenecks, redundancies, and improvement opportunities.
4. **Validate** alignment with business goals and technology. Refine process models with stakeholders and obtain approval.
5. **Maintain and update** process models as business operations evolve.

Roles

- Business Architect (R)
- Business Analyst (C)
- Process Owner (C)
- Lead Enterprise Architect (A)
- Application Architect (I)

Inputs

- Business strategy and objectives
- Stakeholder interviews and workshop results
- Existing process documentation
- System and application documentation
- Performance metrics and pain points

Outputs

- Current state (AS-IS) process documentation
- Process improvement recommendations
- Future state (TO-BE) process models with capability and technology mapping
- Process detail documentation and descriptions

Additional information

- BPMN (Business Process Model and Notation)
- TOGAF Business Architecture
- Value Stream Mapping

Common issues with an immature capability:

- **Missing, inconsistent or outdated documentation** of business processes
- **Lack of standardization** in process modeling notation and tools
- **Disconnect between business processes and IT systems**, resulting in technology that doesn't support business needs.
- **Limited stakeholder engagement** leading to incomplete or inaccurate process models.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- **Use standards** (tools, method, notations etc.)
- **Start with high-level** process models (Level 1-2) and drill down subsequently.
- **Keep models simple** and understandable for non-technical stakeholders.
- **Focus on high-value-adding processes** first, with significant business impact.

Application Architecture - Architecture Validation

Confirm that an architecture is fit for purpose and identify any gaps or issues.

Definition

Architecture Validation involves ensuring that the developed architecture meets the defined requirements and aligns with business goals. It includes verifying the accuracy, completeness, and feasibility of the architecture.

Objectives

Verify that architecture deliverables meet defined requirements, comply with standards and principles, and are feasible for implementation. Identify gaps, risks and issues early to avoid costly rework..

Tasks

1. Review architecture documentation against requirements, principles and standards.
2. **Perform compliance assessments** against architecture policies and guidelines.
3. Assess technical feasibility, risks and implementation readiness.
4. **Conduct validation sessions** with key stakeholders to confirm fit for purpose.
5. Document findings, gaps and **recommendations** for remediation.

Roles

- Business Architect, Application Architect, Data Architect, Technology Architect (R)
- Lead Enterprise Architect (A)

Inputs

- Architecture documentation.
- Requirements specifications.
- Business goals and objectives.
- Guiding principles, standards, policies and guidelines

Outputs

- Validation reports.
- Compliance assessment results.
- Updated architecture documentation.

Additional information

- Architecture Compliance (TOGAF)

Common issues with an immature capability:

- Validation happens too late – issues are discovered during implementation when changes are expensive.
- No clear **validation criteria** – reviews are subjective and inconsistent.
- **Validation is seen as a bottleneck** – projects try to skip or rush through it.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- Define clear **validation criteria** based on architecture principles, standards and requirements.
- **Integrate validation early** in the architecture process – don't wait until the end.
- **Keep reviews lightweight** and constructive – focus on risk-based prioritization, not bureaucracy.

Application Architecture - Application / Solution Architecture Modelling

Design and document application structures to guide development and transformation.

Definition

Application Architecture Modelling involves designing and documenting the structure, components, and interactions of software applications. It provides a blueprint for how applications are composed, relate to each other, and support business capabilities.

Objectives

Ensure that applications are designed and implemented in a way that aligns with business goals and IT strategy.

- Facilitate effective communication and collaboration among stakeholders.
- Support decision-making and prioritization of application development and integration initiatives.

Tasks

1. Analyse the **current application landscape** — document applications, technology stack and lifecycle status.
2. Define application architecture principles, standards and design patterns (e.g. microservices, layered, event-driven).
3. **Design target application architectures** — model components, responsibilities, interactions and data flows.
4. **Identify integration points** and dependencies with other architecture domains.
5. Validate application models with stakeholders and iterate based on feedback.
6. Maintain and update application models as requirements and the technology landscape evolve.

Roles

- Application Architect (R)
- Lead Enterprise Architect (A)
- Enterprise Architect, Solution Architect (C)
- Business Analyst, Technology Architect (I)

Inputs

- Business strategy and objectives
- Current state application documentation
- Stakeholder requirements and expectations
- Architecture Vision and principles
- Application portfolio inventory

Outputs

- Application architecture models (e.g. component diagrams, data flow diagrams)
- Application architecture principles and standards
- Integration points and interfaces documentation
- Architecture Decision Records (ADRs)

Additional information

- TOGAF Information Systems Architecture
- SAP LeanIX Application Portfolio Management

Common issues with an immature capability:

- No standardized way of documenting application architectures — teams use different tools and notations.
- Architecture only done at project level — no enterprise-wide view, leading to silos and duplication.
- Architecture decisions are not documented, leading to repeated debates and inconsistent choices.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- Start with an application portfolio inventory — you can't design what you don't understand.
- Define a standard notation and toolset (e.g. ArchiMate, C4 model).
- Focus on business-critical applications first — not everything needs a detailed model.
- Connect application architecture to business capabilities — this creates relevance and stakeholder buy-in.

Application Architecture – Integration Architecture Modelling

Integrating all applications and components of an IT landscape in an efficient and future-proof way.

Definition

Integration Architecture Modelling is the process of designing and documenting the interactions and data flows between different systems and applications within an enterprise. It ensures seamless communication and data exchange, enhancing overall system efficiency.

Objectives

The objective of Integration Architecture is to facilitate seamless integration of workflows and data streams across applications, systems and companies, focusing on cost efficiency, customer satisfaction, productivity, and maintainability of the IT landscape.

Tasks

1. Identification of integration points and patterns between applications.
2. Define integration architecture principles and standards.
3. Develop detailed integration models, including data flow diagrams, interface specifications and communication protocols.
4. Validate and verify integration models with stakeholders.
5. Maintain and update integration models to reflect changes in the architecture.

Roles

- Application Architect (R)
- Lead Enterprise Architect (A)
- Solution Architect, Technology Architect (C)
- Enterprise Architect (I)

Inputs

- Architecture Vision and other architecture documentation (e.g. principles).
- Stakeholder requirements and expectations.
- Integration points and interfaces documentation.
- Industry standards and best practices.

Outputs

- Integration architecture models, diagrams and reports like interface circle maps, data flow diagrams, interface specifications.
- Integration architecture principles, integration patterns, tools and techniques.

Additional information

- SAP LeanIX – Integration Architecture
- Enterprise Integration Patterns
- The TOGAF Standard – Inform. Systems Architecture

Common issues with an immature capability:

- **Inadequate documentation** of interfaces leads to unplanned efforts and delays in IT transformation projects.
- **Overly complex** IT landscapes due to lack of standardization impacting maintenance, scalability and readiness for change.
- Duplication of efforts and missed opportunities due to a missing overview of integration patterns.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- **Start documenting** the interfaces of the integration architecture in a standard way and setup the required governance to maintain the documentation.
- Develop integration objectives based on the architecture vision, including **integration patterns**, preferred technologies and ways of working.

Data Architecture - Business Object Modelling

Define and structure the key business entities and their relationships

Definition

Business Object Modelling involves **identifying, defining, and documenting the core business entities (objects)**. It establishes a common vocabulary and understanding of what data represents, including attributes, relationships, and business rules, as the base for the data architecture.

Objectives

Create a clear and consistent understanding of business entities across the organization. Establish a **conceptual data model that bridges business terminology and technical data structures**. Enable effective communication between business and IT stakeholders regarding data needs and requirements.

Tasks

1. **Identify core business objects** through stakeholder workshops, process analysis, and business capability mapping (e.g., Customer, Product, Order, Contract).
2. **Define business objects**, including their purpose, key attributes, definitions, ownership.
3. **Document business rules** that govern business objects (e.g., validation rules, lifecycle states, constraints).
4. **Validate and align business objects** with stakeholders and business processes.
5. **Maintain and evolve** the business object model as the business changes.

Roles

- Data Architect (A)
- Business Architect (R)
- Business Analyst (C)
- Data Owner/Steward (C)
- Lead Enterprise Architect (I)

Inputs

- Business strategy and objectives
- Business capability model
- Process models and documentation
- Existing data models and definitions
- Stakeholder requirements

Outputs

- Conceptual data model (business object model)
- Business object definitions and glossary
- Business rules documentation
- Business object to process/capability mapping

Additional information

- TOGAF Data Architecture
- Data Management Body of Knowledge (DMBOK)

Common issues with an immature capability:

- **Inconsistent terminology** across different departments and systems, leading to confusion about what data represents.
- **Lack of clear data ownership**, resulting in poor data quality and unclear accountability.
- **Gap between business concepts and technical implementation**.
- **Missing business rules** leading to data quality issues and integration problems.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- **Start top-down** with critical business objects that have the highest business impact (e.g., customer, product) – conceptually, what the business needs, not how it's technically implemented.
- **Use simple, business-friendly notation.**
- **Establish a business glossary**
- **Validate** by engaging data owners and business experts.
- Link business objects to processes, capabilities, and applications.

Data Architecture - Data Architecture Modelling

Design logical and physical data structures that implement business objects

Definition

Data Architecture Modelling involves creating detailed logical and physical data models that **translate business objects into implementable data structures.** It defines how data is organized, stored, and accessed, ensuring data consistency, integrity, and optimal performance.

Objectives

Transform conceptual business objects into logical and physical data models that can be implemented in databases and systems. Ensure data structures support business requirements while maintaining data quality, integrity, and performance. Enable effective database design and data integration across the enterprise.

Tasks

1. **Translate business objects into logical data models**, defining entities, attributes, primary/foreign keys, and relationships.
2. **Define data types, constraints, and validation rules** at the technical level.
3. **Apply data modeling principles** including normalization, referential integrity, and data standardization.
4. **Create physical data models** optimized for specific database platforms and performance requirements.
5. **Validate data models** with stakeholders (data owners, architects, developers) and ensure alignment with business requirements.
6. **Maintain and evolve** data models as business and technical requirements change.

Roles

- Data Architect (A)
- Database Administrator
- Application Architect
- Data Owner/Steward
- Lead Enterprise Architect

Inputs

- Conceptual data model (business object model)
- Business requirements and use cases
- Existing database schemas and data models
- Performance and scalability requirements
- Technology standards and database platforms

Outputs

- Logical data models (entity-relationship diagrams, ERDs)
- Physical data models (database schemas and specs)
- Data dictionary and metadata documentation
- Data model to business object mapping
- Data integrity and validation rules

Additional information

- Data Modeling Techniques (Normalization, Denormalization)
- TOGAF Data Architecture
- DAMA-DMBOK Data Modeling

Common issues with an immature capability:

- **Inconsistent data models** across systems, data silos and integration challenges.
- **Poor normalization** or over-normalization, causing performance issues or data redundancy.
- **Lack of standardization** in naming conventions, data types, and methods.
- **Disconnect between logical and physical models**, implementation gaps.
- **Inadequate documentation**, making maintenance and evolution difficult.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- **Structure leads physical**: Define logical models before physical implementation.
- Validate with both business and technical stakeholders
- **Use standard notation** (e.g., ERD, UML) and consistent naming conventions.
- **Balance normalization with performance**
- **Model for reusability** - design data structures shared across applications.
- Document data dictionaries, definitions, and rationale **— keep evolution in mind.**

Data Architecture - Data Flow Modelling

Map and optimize how data moves between systems, applications, and processes across the enterprise.

Definition

Data Flow Modelling involves documenting and analyzing **how data moves, transforms, and integrates across systems, applications, and business processes**. It captures data sources, destinations, transformation logic, integration points, and dependencies.

Objectives

Create comprehensive **visibility of data lineages and movement** across the enterprise and beyond to support integration planning, impact analysis, and data governance. Identify data transformation requirements, integration patterns, and dependencies. Enable effective troubleshooting and optimization of data flows.

Tasks

1. **Identify data sources and destinations** across systems, applications, and external partners.
2. **Document data flows and transformations** between systems, documenting how data moves from source to target.
3. **Define integration points and patterns** (e.g., real-time, batch, API, ETL/ELT, messaging).
4. **Establish data lineage** showing origin, movement, and transformation of data throughout lifecycle (esp. regulatory or business-critical data).
5. **Identify dependencies and impacts** - what happens if a data source or flow is changed or unavailable.
6. **Validate** data flows with stakeholders (data owners, integration architects, application teams).
7. **Maintain and update** data flow models as integrations evolve.

Roles

- Data Architect (A)
- Application Architect
- Data Owner/Steward
- Lead Enterprise Architect

Inputs

- Business processes and requirements
- Application architecture and integration landscape
- Data architecture models (logical/physical)
- Existing interface, API and integration documentation
- Data quality and governance requirements

Outputs

- Data flow diagrams (context, detailed level)
- Data lineage documentation
- Data transformation, dependency and impact analysis
- Interface specifications.

Additional information

- Data Flow Diagrams (DFD)
- TOGAF Data Architecture
- Data Lineage and Impact Analysis

Common issues with an immature capability:

- **Undocumented** or poorly documented integrations.
- **Lack of data lineage visibility**, preventing impact analysis.
- **Point-to-point integrations** ("spaghetti"), less integration patterns or governance.
- **Unknown data transformations**, data quality and reconciliation problems.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- **Start with high-impact critical data flows** that support key business processes.
- **Use visual models** (data flow diagrams) at different levels of detail.
- Document both the "what" and "how" - what data flows, and how it's transformed.
- **Identify and standardize integration patterns** - avoid point-to-point spaghetti.
- Link to business processes and applications to show business context and impact.
- **Collaborate with integration and application teams**.
- Perform impact analysis before making changes to data flows or integrations.

Technology Architecture – System Architecture Modelling

Define and design the technical systems and infrastructure components

Definition

System Architecture Modelling involves **designing and documenting the technical infrastructure and system components** that host and run business applications. It defines servers, compute resources, operating systems, middleware, databases, and their configurations.

Objectives

Design **robust and scalable system architectures** that support application requirements while **optimizing performance, availability, security, and cost.** Ensure consistent standards and patterns across the technical infrastructure. Enable effective capacity planning, disaster recovery, and operational management.

Tasks

1. **Identify system requirements** from application architecture, business requirements, and non-functional requirements.
2. **Define system components**, topology and configuration for servers, compute, operating systems, middleware, data platforms, and storage – their deployment, connection, and configuration.
3. **Apply system architecture** patterns and standards (e.g., high availability, load balancing, clustering, redundancy).
4. **Define sizing and capacity** requirements based on workload analysis and growth projections.
5. **Document security & compliance and validate system architecture** with stakeholders (application architects, infrastructure teams, security).
6. **Maintain and evolve** system architecture as technology and business requirements change.

Roles

- Technology Architect (A)
- Application Architect
- System Administrator
- Lead Enterprise Architect

Inputs

- Application architecture and requirements
- Non-functional requirements
- Technology standards and reference architectures
- Existing infrastructure, capacity and performance data
- Budget and cost constraints

Outputs

- System architecture diagrams and models
- System component, capacity and sizing specifications
- Deployment architecture documentation
- High availability and disaster recovery designs
- Security and compliance requirements

Additional information

- TOGAF Technology Architecture
- Infrastructure Reference Models
- Cloud Architecture Patterns

Common issues with an immature capability:

- **Inconsistent system designs** across different applications and environments.
- **Over- or under-provisioning** due to lack of proper sizing and capacity planning.
- **Lack of standardization** in system platforms, configurations, and patterns.
- **Inadequate disaster recovery** planning.
- **Security gaps** due to inconsistent hardening and configuration standards.
- **High operational costs** from inefficient infrastructure design and complexity.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- **Start with non-functional requirements**: performance, availability, scalability.
- **Use reference architectures and proven patterns** – leverage cloud-first.
- **Balance cost, performance, and resilience** - optimize for business value.
- **Standardize** - reduce complexity and operational overhead.
- **Design for observability** - build monitoring, logging & diagnostics from the start.
- **Design for automation** and ensure operational feasibility.
- Document - include diagrams, specifications, and rationale for design decisions.

Technology Architecture – Network Architecture Modelling

Design and optimize the network infrastructure that enables secure and reliable connectivity.

Definition

Network Architecture Modelling involves **designing and documenting the network infrastructure and connectivity** that enables communication between systems, applications, users, and external partners. It defines the network topology and its components.

Objectives

Design robust and secure network architectures that support business connectivity requirements while optimizing performance, availability, security, and cost. Ensure consistent network standards and patterns across the enterprise. Enable effective network planning, security segmentation, and operational management.

Tasks

1. **Identify network requirements** from application architecture, business requirements, and non-functional requirements.
2. Design network **topology**, segmentation, security zones, based on security and compliance requirements.
3. Define **connectivity**, capacity and performance for different scenarios (site-to-site, remote access, cloud connectivity, partner integration).
4. Apply **network architecture patterns** and standards (e.g., redundancy, high availability, traffic management, Quality of Service).
5. **Validate** network architecture with stakeholders (security architects, infrastructure teams, application architects). Document security and compliance requirements.
6. **Maintain** and evolve network architecture as technology and business requirements change.

Roles

- Technology Architect (A)
- Security Architect (R)
- Application Architect (C)
- Lead Enterprise Architect (I)

Inputs

- Application architecture and connectivity requirements
- Non-functional requirements
- Technology standards and reference architectures
- Existing network infrastructure, topology and usage data.
- Security and compliance policies, cost constraints

Outputs

- Network architecture diagrams and topology models
- Network component specifications and configurations
- Network segmentation and security zone design
- High availability, capacity and performance design.
- Security and compliance requirements

Additional information

- TOGAF Technology Architecture
- Network Reference Models
- Zero Trust Network Architecture

Common issues with an immature capability:

- **Inconsistent network** designs across environments, creating complexity.
- **Performance bottlenecks** due to inadequate capacity planning or poor traffic management.
- **Single points of failure** and inadequate redundancy planning.
- **Complex firewall rules** that are difficult to manage and audit..
- **Poor visibility** into network traffic and security events.
- **High costs** from over-provisioning or inefficient network design.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- **Start with security requirements** - segmentation and security zones first.
- **Use reference architectures and proven patterns.**
- **Design for zero-trust principles** – and segment based on risk.
- **Standardize on platforms and patterns** - reduce complexity and ops overhead.
- **Plan for redundancy and failover** - eliminate single points of failures.
- **Automate** network management and Build in monitoring and **observability.**
- **Document** clearly - include rationale for design decisions.

NEW PROPOSED DRAFT

Technology Architecture – Virtualization Architecture Modelling

Design virtualized and containerized infrastructure to optimize resource utilization, agility, scalability.

Definition

Virtualization Architecture Modelling involves designing and documenting **virtualized compute, storage, and network resources**, including virtual machines, containers, and cloud-based infrastructure.

Objectives

Design flexible and efficient virtualization architectures that optimize resource utilization while supporting application requirements for performance, availability, and scalability. Enable rapid provisioning and deployment of infrastructure. Support modern application patterns including microservices, cloud-native, and hybrid cloud architectures.

Tasks

1. Identify virtualization requirements from application architecture, business requirements, and non-functional requirements.
2. **Define virtualization strategy and platforms** including hypervisors, container platforms, and cloud services.
3. **Define topology, orchestration, automation**, scaling, and lifecycle management of virtualized resources.
4. Apply virtualization patterns and standards (e.g., resource optimization, high availability, disaster recovery). Design for cloud-native and hybrid architectures where appropriate.
5. Document security and compliance requirements. Validate virtualization architecture with stakeholders and ensure feasibility.
6. Maintain and evolve virtualization architecture as technology and business requirements change.

Roles

- Technology Architect (A)
- Application Architect (C)
- Lead Enterprise Architect (I)

Inputs

- Application architecture and requirements
- Non-functional requirements (performance, scalability, availability, portability)
- Technology standards and reference architectures
- Existing virtualization and cloud infrastructure

Outputs

- Virtualization architecture diagrams and models
- Platform specifications, container and orchestration designs
- Resource allocation and capacity specifications
- Cloud integration and hybrid architecture designs

Additional information

- TOGAF Technology Architecture
- • Cloud Native Computing Foundation (CNCF)
- • Container Orchestration Patterns

Common issues with an immature capability:

- **Inconsistent virtualization** approaches across environments, creating **complexity and operational overhead.**
- Resource sprawl and inefficient utilization due to lack of proper governance and monitoring.
- Poor container strategy, leading to unmanaged proliferation and security risks.
- **Vendor lock-in from over-reliance** on proprietary virtualization or cloud platforms.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- Start with workload analysis and understand application requirements. Use reference architectures and standardize on platforms.
- **Design for cloud-native** where appropriate - embrace containers and orchestration for modern applications.
- Plan for hybrid and multi-cloud - design for portability and avoid vendor lock-in.
- Automate provisioning and lifecycle management. **Build in observability** for resource utilization, performance, and costs.

NEW PROPOSED DRAFT

Architecture Repository – Dashboards, Views, Reports

Turn architecture data into actionable insights for informed decision-making.

Definition

Designing, building and maintaining visual **dashboards, standardized views and reports** that present architecture data in a clear, actionable format for different stakeholder groups.

Objectives

Provide stakeholders with **timely, relevant and easy-to-understand insights into the architecture landscape**. Enable data-driven decision-making by translating complex architecture data into meaningful visualizations. Reduce manual reporting effort through standardized and automated outputs.

Tasks

1. **Identify reporting needs** and key questions per stakeholder group (e.g. CIO, project managers, domain architects).
2. Define and **design dashboard layouts**, views and report templates.
3. Implement dashboards and reports using the EA tooling platform (e.g. LeanIX, Mega, ServiceNow).
4. Automate data feeds from the architecture repository to dashboards where possible.
5. Maintain, update and continuously improve dashboards and reports based on stakeholder feedback.

Roles

- EA Repository Manager / EA Analyst (R)
- Lead Enterprise Architect (A)
- Domain Architects (C)
- Stakeholders (I)

Inputs

- Architecture Repository data (applications, technologies, capabilities, etc.)
- Stakeholder reporting requirements
- EA governance KPIs and metrics
- Data quality assessments

Outputs

- Stakeholder-specific dashboards and views
- Standardized architecture reports (e.g. application landscape, technology lifecycle, capability coverage)
- KPI/metric visualizations

Additional information

- TOGAF Architecture Repository
- LeanIX / Mega / ServiceNow CSDM reporting capabilities
- ArchiMate Viewpoints

Common issues with an immature capability:

- Reports are created manually and ad-hoc, leading to inconsistency and high effort.
- Dashboards exist but are not used because they don't answer the right questions.
- Data in reports is outdated or inaccurate due to poor data quality in the repository.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- Start with 3–5 key views that answer the most critical stakeholder questions.
- Ensure data quality first – a beautiful dashboard with wrong data destroys trust.
- Automate where possible, but keep it simple – avoid over-engineering.
- Review dashboards quarterly with stakeholders to ensure continued relevance.

Architecture Repository – Data Gathering & Data Quality

Ensure architecture decisions are based on reliable, complete and up-to-date data.

Definition

Establishing and operating processes to systematically **collect, validate and maintain architecture data across the organization**, ensuring a high level of data quality, completeness and consistency in the architecture repository.

Objectives

Ensure that **the architecture repository contains accurate, complete and current data** as the foundation for all architecture activities. Define clear data ownership, collection processes and quality standards. Minimize manual data gathering effort through integration with existing data sources.

Tasks

1. **Define the data scope and data model** for the architecture repository (what entities, attributes and relationships are needed).
2. Identify and connect **data sources** (e.g. CMDB, ITSM, HR systems, project portfolio tools).
3. Establish **data collection processes** – automated feeds where possible, structured manual input where necessary.
4. Define data **quality rules, validation checks and quality KPIs** (e.g. completeness, accuracy, timeliness).
5. Assign data **owners and stewards** responsible for maintaining data in their domain.
6. Conduct regular data quality reviews and remediation cycles.

Roles

- EA Repository Manager / EA Analyst (R)
- Lead Enterprise Architect (A)
- Data Owners / Stewards (C)
- Domain Architects (C)

Inputs

- EA data model and repository structure
- Existing data sources (CMDB, ITSM, PPM, HR, etc.)
- Data quality requirements from stakeholders
- Architecture governance policies

Outputs

- Populated and up-to-date architecture repository
- Data quality reports and scorecards
- Data ownership matrix
- Documented data collection processes and integration interfaces

Additional information

- TOGAF Architecture Repository
- DMBOK – Data Quality Management
- Integration patterns (API, ETL, manual import)

Common issues with an immature capability:

- Repository data is outdated, incomplete or inconsistent because no one owns it.
- Data is gathered manually via spreadsheets, leading to high effort and errors.
- No clear definition of what data is needed, resulting in either too much noise or critical gaps.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- **Start small** – focus on the data needed for your top 3–5 dashboards and views first.
- Assign **clear data owners** – without ownership, data quality will always degrade.
- **Automate** data feeds from existing sources (CMDB, ITSM) before asking people to fill in data manually.
- Establish a simple quality rhythm: quarterly reviews with data owners **to validate and refresh.**

Architecture Repository – Repository Support & Maintenance

Keep the architecture repository operational, reliable and fit for evolving organizational needs.

Definition

Managing the day-to-day operations, technical maintenance and continuous improvement of the architecture repository platform, ensuring its availability, usability and alignment with evolving EA requirements.

Objectives

Ensure the architecture repository is stable, performant and available for all EA stakeholders. Maintain the repository structure, tooling and integrations as organizational needs evolve. Provide user support and enablement to drive adoption and effective usage of the repository.

Tasks

1. Manage the EA repository platform (e.g. LeanIX, Mega, ServiceNow) including configuration, access management and upgrades.
2. Maintain and evolve the repository meta-model and data structure as EA requirements change.
3. Manage integrations with connected systems (CMDB, ITSM, PPM, etc.) and ensure data flows are operational.
4. Provide user support – handle requests, issues and questions from architects and stakeholders.
5. Develop and maintain user guidelines, templates and onboarding materials.
6. Monitor platform usage, performance and adoption metrics; identify and implement improvements.

Roles

- EA Repository Manager / EA Tool Administrator (R)
- Lead Enterprise Architect (A)
- IT Operations / Platform Support (C)
- Domain Architects & EA Users (I)

Inputs

- EA repository platform and infrastructure
- User feedback and support requests
- EA meta-model and data model requirements
- Integration specifications and SLAs with connected systems

Outputs

- Operational and up-to-date repository platform
- Updated meta-model and repository configuration
- User guidelines, templates and training materials
- Platform usage and adoption reports, resolved support tickets

Additional information

- TOGAF Architecture Repository
- EA Tool vendor documentation (LeanIX, Mega, etc.)
- ITIL Service Management practices

Common issues with an immature capability:

- The repository tool is set up but nobody maintains it – meta-model drifts, integrations break, data becomes stale.
- Low adoption because users find the tool complex, unclear or poorly documented.
- No dedicated ownership – repository maintenance is "everyone's and no one's job."

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- Assign a dedicated repository owner with clear accountability.
- Keep the meta-model simple and evolve incrementally – avoid over-modelling upfront.
- Invest in user onboarding and short how-to guides – adoption depends on usability.
- Monitor usage regularly – if nobody uses it, find out why and fix it before adding more features.

Architecture Management – Organization Development

Build and evolve the EA organization to effectively deliver architecture capabilities.

Definition

Designing, establishing and continuously improving the EA organizational structure, including team setup, roles, competencies and career paths, to ensure the EA function is adequately staffed and positioned within the organization.

Objectives

Define and maintain an effective EA organizational structure that supports the delivery of architecture services. Ensure the right skills, competencies and capacity are available to meet current and future EA demands. Establish clear career paths and development opportunities to attract and retain EA talent.

Tasks

1. Define the EA organizational model and reporting structure (e.g. centralized, federated, hybrid).
2. Define EA roles, job profiles and required competencies per role.
3. Assess current team capabilities against required competencies – identify gaps.
4. Develop hiring plans, training paths and career development frameworks for EA staff.
5. Continuously evaluate and adapt the EA organization to changing business needs and maturity levels.
6. Foster collaboration models between central EA and domain/solution architects across the organization.

Roles

- Lead Enterprise Architect (R)
- CIO / CTO (A)
- HR Business Partner (C)
- Domain Architects (I)

Inputs

- Business and IT strategy
- Current EA team structure and skill profiles
- EA capability maturity assessment results
- HR policies and frameworks

Outputs

- EA organizational model and reporting structure
- EA role descriptions and competency matrix
- Skills gap analysis and development plans
- Collaboration model between central and federated EA roles

Additional information

- TOGAF EA Governance – Organization Structure
- EA Skills Framework (SFIA)

Common issues with an immature capability:

- EA roles are unclear or overlapping, leading to confusion about who does what.
- EA team is understaffed or lacks critical skills, but no structured plan exists to address this.
- EA is positioned too far from business or too deep in IT, limiting its effectiveness and influence.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- Start with clearly defined roles and responsibilities – even a small team needs clarity.
- Align the EA org model to the company's operating model – don't copy a template blindly.
- Revisit the org setup as EA maturity grows – what works at Level 1 won't work at Level 3.

Architecture Management – EA Performance Management

Measure, evaluate and demonstrate the value and effectiveness of Enterprise Architecture.

Definition

Establishing and operating a framework to define, measure and report on the performance and value contribution of the EA function, ensuring continuous alignment with business objectives and stakeholder expectations.

Objectives

Make the impact and value of **EA visible and measurable for stakeholders**. Enable data-driven improvement of EA services, processes and capabilities. Ensure accountability and transparency of the EA function.

Tasks

1. Define EA performance goals aligned with business and IT strategy.
2. Identify and establish KPIs and metrics (e.g. stakeholder satisfaction, architecture compliance rate, time-to-decision, repository adoption).
3. Implement measurement and data collection mechanisms.
4. Produce regular performance reports and present to key stakeholders.
5. Analyse results, identify improvement areas and drive corrective actions.

Roles

- Lead Enterprise Architect (R)
- CIO / CTO (A)
- Domain Architects (C)
- EA Repository Manager (C)

Inputs

- Business and IT strategy and goals
- EA capability maturity assessment results
- Stakeholder feedback and satisfaction data
- Repository usage and data quality metrics

Outputs

- EA KPI framework and metric definitions
- Periodic EA performance reports and dashboards
- Improvement recommendations and action plans
- Stakeholder communication on EA value contribution

Additional information

- TOGAF EA Governance – Performance Management
- Balanced Scorecard approach for EA

Common issues with an immature capability:

- EA cannot demonstrate its value, leading to budget cuts and loss of management support.
- Metrics are either not defined or too technical – they don't resonate with business stakeholders.
- Performance data is collected but never acted upon – reporting without improvement.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- Start with 3–5 meaningful KPIs that business stakeholders care about – avoid metric overload.
- Combine quantitative metrics with qualitative feedback (e.g. stakeholder interviews).
- Report regularly and visibly – if nobody sees it, it doesn't count.

Architecture Management – EA Process Development

Define, standardize and continuously improve the processes that drive EA delivery.

Definition

Designing, documenting and continuously improving the core EA processes, ensuring a consistent, repeatable and efficient way of working across all architecture activities.

Objectives

Establish standardized EA processes that ensure consistency and quality across all architecture work. Enable scalability of the EA function by reducing dependency on individual knowledge. Drive continuous process improvement based on maturity assessments and lessons learned.

Tasks

1. **Identify and define** core EA processes (e.g. architecture development, review, governance, repository management).
2. Document processes including activities, roles, inputs, outputs and decision points.
3. Align EA processes with **existing organizational frameworks** (e.g. project methodology, ITIL, SAFe).
4. Conduct periodic process maturity assessments and identify improvement areas.
5. Implement process improvements and track their effectiveness.

Roles

- Lead Enterprise Architect (R)
- CIO / CTO (A)
- Domain Architects (C)
- EA Analysts (C)

Inputs

- EA capability and process maturity assessment results
- Existing organizational process frameworks
- Lessons learned and feedback from EA practitioners
- Industry best practices and reference frameworks

Outputs

- Documented EA process descriptions and workflows
- EA process maturity assessment results
- Process improvement backlog and action plans
- Updated EA methodology and ways of working

Additional information

- TOGAF ADM and process guidance
- EA Process Maturity Model

Common issues with an immature capability:

- EA work is done differently by every architect – **no consistent methodology** or quality standard.
- Processes exist on paper but are not followed in practice.
- No mechanism to learn and improve – the same mistakes are repeated.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- Start by documenting the **3–5 most critical processes** – don't try to formalize everything at once.
- Keep processes lightweight and practical – architects won't follow bureaucratic overhead.
- Use maturity assessments as a driver – they show where process gaps hurt the most.

Architecture Management – EA Knowledge Management

Capture and share architecture knowledge to reduce key-person dependency.

Definition

Establishing practices and platforms to systematically capture, organize, share and reuse architecture knowledge, decisions, patterns and lessons learned across the EA function and the wider organization.

Objectives

Ensure critical architecture knowledge is documented and accessible – not locked in individuals' heads. Accelerate onboarding of new architects and enable consistent decision-making. Foster a culture of knowledge sharing and continuous learning within the EA community.

Tasks

1. Define the knowledge scope – what needs to be captured (e.g. architecture decisions, patterns, reference architectures, lessons learned).
2. Establish a knowledge platform or wiki (e.g. Confluence, SharePoint) with a clear structure and taxonomy.
3. Integrate knowledge management into daily EA work – capture decisions and rationale as part of the architecture process.
4. Facilitate regular knowledge sharing sessions (e.g. architecture community of practice, brown bags).
5. Maintain and curate knowledge base – archive outdated content, ensure findability and relevance.

Roles

- Lead Enterprise Architect (R)
- Domain Architects (R)
- EA Analysts (C)
- All EA stakeholders (I)

Inputs

- Architecture decisions and decision logs
- Reference architectures, patterns and templates
- Lessons learned from projects and reviews
- EA process documentation and guidelines

Outputs

- Structured EA knowledge base / wiki
- Architecture decision records (ADRs)
- Reference architecture and pattern library
- Knowledge sharing session materials and recordings

Additional information

- Architecture Decision Records (ADR) practice
- TOGAF Architecture Repository – Guidance & Templates

Common issues with an immature capability:

- Critical knowledge **exists only in people's heads** – when they leave, the knowledge is gone.
- Documentation exists but is scattered, outdated or unfindable.
- No culture of knowledge sharing – architects work in silos.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- Start with architecture decision records – lightweight, high-value, immediately useful.
- Make knowledge capture part of the process, not an afterthought – **"no decision without a record."**
- Keep it simple – a well-structured wiki beats an over-engineered knowledge management tool.

Architecture Management – Stakeholder Management

Foster stakeholder support and involvement and ensure effective communication and collaboration.

Definition

Stakeholder Management involves identifying, analysing, and engaging stakeholders to ensure their needs and concerns are addressed throughout the architecture development process. It aims to build and maintain stakeholder support and alignment.

Objectives

To ensure effective communication and collaboration with stakeholders, fostering their support and involvement in the architecture process. Align stakeholder expectations with architecture priorities and decisions. Build long-term trust and engagement across business and IT.

Tasks

1. Identify stakeholders and **create a stakeholder map**. Assign priorities and identify preferred communication channels, styles and frequencies.
2. Analyse stakeholder interests and influence.
3. Develop stakeholder engagement strategies.
4. Plan the **stakeholder communication and engagement.**
5. Regularly collect stakeholder feedback on EA services and adjust engagement approach accordingly.
6. Manage escalations and resolve conflicting stakeholder interests in alignment with architecture priorities.

Roles

- Application Architect, Data Architect, Technology Architect (R)
- Lead Enterprise Architect (A)

Inputs

- Business strategy and goals.
- Stakeholder requirements and concerns.
- Existing stakeholder documentation.

Outputs

- Stakeholder map.
- Stakeholder analysis reports.
- Communication and engagement plans.

Additional information

- TOGAF Stakeholder Management

Common issues with an immature capability:

- **Lack of trust, support** and **stakeholder engagement** for transformation initiatives.
- **Ambiguity** around stakeholder **roles** and **responsibilities**, causing confusion and inefficiencies in decision-making and execution.
- Even **getting a list of relevant stakeholders** requires time and effort.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- Identify stakeholders, document a **stakeholder map** and prioritize needs and expectations.
- Develop a **communication plan** to keep stakeholders informed and engaged.
- Tailor communication to the audience – executives need different messages than project teams.

Governance – Standards, Policies, Principles, Guidelines

Establish the guardrails that ensure consistency and alignment across all architecture decisions.

Definition

Defining, maintaining and communicating the set of architecture principles, standards, policies and guidelines that govern how architecture is developed, implemented and managed across the organization.

Objectives

Provide clear and actionable guardrails that guide architecture decisions and ensure consistency. Ensure alignment of architecture work with business strategy, regulatory requirements and industry best practices. Enable autonomous decision-making by architects within a defined framework.

Tasks

1. Define **architecture principles** that reflect business values and strategic direction.
2. Establish technology standards and policies (e.g. approved platforms, security requirements, integration patterns).
3. Develop practical guidelines that translate principles and standards into **actionable guidance** for architects and project teams.
4. Implement a review and approval process for new or updated standards.
5. **Communicate and socialize** principles, standards and guidelines across the organization.
6. Periodically review and update to ensure continued relevance.

Roles

- Lead Enterprise Architect (R)
- Architecture Review Board (A)
- Domain Architects (C)
- CIO / CTO (I)

Inputs

- Business and IT strategy
- Regulatory and compliance requirements
- Industry standards and best practices
- Architecture decision logs and lessons learned

Outputs

- Architecture principles catalogue
- Technology standards and policies documentation
- Architecture guidelines and design patterns
- Standards review and update log

Additional information

- TOGAF Architecture Principles
- ISO/IEC 42010 – Architecture Description

Common issues with an immature capability:

- **No defined standards** – every project makes its own technology choices, creating fragmentation.
- Standards exist but are not communicated or enforced – they live in a document nobody reads.
- Standards are **too rigid or outdated**, leading architects to bypass them.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- Start with 5–10 core principles and a manageable set of technology standards – less is more.
- Make them **visible and easy to find** – embed in onboarding, project kickoffs and review processes.
- Build in a waiver process – rigid rules without exceptions kill adoption.

Governance – Architecture Training

Build architecture skills and awareness across the organization to drive EA adoption.

Definition

Planning, developing and delivering training programs that build architecture knowledge, skills and awareness among EA team members, IT staff and business stakeholders.

Objectives

Ensure EA team members have the skills and knowledge to effectively perform their roles. Raise architecture awareness among business and IT stakeholders to foster collaboration and adoption. Establish a continuous learning culture within the EA community.

Tasks

1. Assess training needs based on role requirements, skill gaps and EA maturity targets.
2. Develop a **training catalogue** covering EA frameworks, tools, methods and soft skills.
3. Deliver training through appropriate formats (e.g. workshops, e-learning, certifications, lunch & learns).
4. **Onboard new architects** with a structured EA onboarding program.
5. Evaluate training effectiveness and continuously update the training offering.

Roles

- Lead Enterprise Architect (R)
- HR / Learning & Development (C)
- Domain Architects (C)
- EA team members and stakeholders (I)

Inputs

- EA role descriptions and competency matrix
- Skills gap analysis results
- EA tools and methodology documentation
- Stakeholder feedback and training requests

Outputs

- EA training catalogue and learning paths
- Training materials and session recordings
- Training completion and effectiveness reports
- Onboarding program for new EA team members

Additional information

- TOGAF certification program
- EA Skills Framework (SFIA)

Common issues with an immature capability:

- No structured training – new architects learn by trial and error, leading to inconsistent quality.
- Training focuses only on tools and frameworks, neglecting communication and stakeholder skills.
- Knowledge stays with senior architects – no mechanism to transfer it to the broader team.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- Start with a structured onboarding program – the fastest way to improve consistency.
- Combine formal training with peer learning (e.g. community of practice, shadowing).
- **Don't forget soft skills** – an architect who can't communicate will struggle regardless of technical depth.

Governance – Communication & Change Management

Drive awareness, understanding and adoption of Enterprise Architecture across the organization.

Definition

Planning and executing communication and change management activities to ensure that architecture initiatives, decisions and standards are understood, accepted and adopted by all relevant stakeholders.

Objectives

Ensure architecture decisions, standards and changes are effectively communicated to all affected parties. Drive organizational adoption of EA practices by managing resistance and building buy-in. Position EA as a valued and trusted function within the organization.

Tasks

1. Develop an EA communication strategy and plan covering target audiences, channels, frequency and key messages.
2. Create and distribute regular EA communications (e.g. newsletters, architecture updates, decision summaries).
3. Identify change impacts of architecture decisions and develop change management approaches.
4. Engage stakeholders through targeted formats (e.g. town halls, roadshows, architecture days).
5. Monitor adoption and gather feedback to continuously improve communication and change efforts.

Roles

- Lead Enterprise Architect (R)
- Communications / Change Manager (C)
- Domain Architects (C)
- CIO / CTO (I)

Inputs

- Architecture decisions and roadmaps
- Stakeholder map and communication preferences
- Change impact assessments
- Stakeholder feedback and adoption metrics

Outputs

- EA communication strategy and plan
- Communication materials (newsletters, updates, presentations)
- Change impact assessments and mitigation plans
- Adoption and feedback reports

Additional information

- TOGAF Stakeholder Management & Communication
- Prosci / ADKAR Change Management framework

Common issues with an immature capability:

- EA works in an **ivory tower** – great architecture that nobody knows about or follows.
- Communication is ad-hoc and reactive – stakeholders only hear from EA when there's a problem.
- Architecture changes are pushed without change management, leading to resistance and workarounds.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- Establish a regular communication rhythm – visibility builds trust and credibility.
- Tailor messages to the audience – executives need different content than developers.
- **Treat every architecture change as a people change** – adoption requires more than a slide deck.

Governance – Architecture Compliance Evaluation

Ensure architecture decisions and implementations adhere to defined standards and principles.

Definition

Assessing and evaluating whether projects, solutions and implementations comply with established architecture principles, standards, policies and guidelines, and managing deviations through a structured waiver process.

Objectives

Ensure that architecture standards and principles are consistently applied across projects and implementations. Identify and manage non-compliance early to reduce technical debt and architectural drift. Provide transparency on compliance status to support governance and decision-making.

Tasks

1. Define compliance evaluation criteria based on architecture principles, standards and policies.
2. Conduct **architecture compliance reviews** at key project milestones (e.g. design, build, go-live).
3. Document compliance findings, deviations and associated risks.
4. Manage a structured **waiver process** for justified deviations – including conditions and expiry.
5. Report compliance status to the Architecture Review Board and relevant stakeholders.

Roles

- Domain Architects (R)
- Architecture Review Board (A)
- Lead Enterprise Architect (C)
- Project / Solution Architects (I)

Inputs

- Architecture principles, standards and policies
- Project and solution architecture documentation
- Waiver requests and deviation justifications
- Previous compliance review findings

Outputs

- Compliance assessment reports
- Deviation and waiver register
- Risk assessments for non-compliant decisions
- Compliance status dashboards and trend reports

Additional information

- TOGAF Architecture Compliance Review
- Architecture Review Board charter and process

Common issues with an immature capability:

- No formal compliance checks – deviations are only discovered in production when it's too late.
- Compliance is perceived as a bottleneck – projects avoid or bypass architecture reviews.
- Waivers are granted informally without tracking, leading to unmanaged technical debt.

Pragmatic approach – essentials that are needed for success:

- Keep reviews lightweight and integrated into existing project gates – don't add bureaucracy.
- Focus on high-risk and high-impact projects first – not everything needs a full review.
- A good waiver process is essential – saying **"no" without an alternative kills credibility.**